

Be receptive to contrary point of view!

As social beings, our lives are deeply **intertwined** with communication, but the same can **often** become a source of conflict

We are social beings. Communication with others is as **integral** to us as breathing. We often find **conflicting** conversations **blowing out of proportion**, sometimes **leading to** even a break in relationships. **Unpleasantness** can be avoided if we are **mindful of** others. We had lived in bungalows in well-planned colonies for a better part of our lives.

It was easy to be more social in such surroundings when we met only on social occasions. **We**, and more like us, **have** moved to **condominium complexes** only over the past few years. Private spaces are diminishing as neighbours fall over each other, literally and figuratively.

This is a new life that we are still adjusting to. I noticed something different about a neighbour recently as we gathered for a meeting. We **indulged** in some **idle banter** before the start of serious business. It was a **light-hearted** conversation, over which we could smile or **chuckle**. Or so I thought, till I received his call the next day. I got the message loud and clear that he was upset over the reference to his receding hairline. I apologised **profusely** for the **faux pas**. He does not seem to have forgiven me and has stopped greeting me when we cross each other during walks.

He is the same person who does not think twice before breaking into a **sarcastic verse** on the community WhatsApp group, without **considering** the hurt he might cause to the intended victim. We have regular meetings with the governing body of our welfare association.

There are arguments **galore** on any subject, which would not be such a bad thing, and may sometimes even be considered as a **humorous interlude** in an otherwise charged environment, were it not for the **seriousness** with which the **adversaries** try to push their viewpoint to the exclusion of even listening to the other's perspective.

One morning, one of the members told me that it was good that he was now a part of the management body, otherwise he would have **vehemently** opposed some of the proposals. I could not **fathom** the logic. A wrong could not have been right only by his being inside the team. In yet another instance recently, two ladies insisted that they were right in their respective **contentions**.

As the arguments **went back and forth**, I could see the **gradual stubborn** look on the faces of both, an indication that they were no longer listening to each other. As an independent observer, I realized that both were talking the same, **albeit** in different words.

They were not taking the time to pause and **reflect** before responding. There is one more incident that I may not forget easily. I felt **aggrieved** enough to write to the promoter of our condominium complex about the supposed **transgressions** of a neighbour in handling the community affairs. The latter was

still working as an employee with the builder. I was upset and did not **deem** it fit to consider the latter's point of view or the **adverse** impact that it might have on his professional **prospects**. I apologised to him in later years. He has moved on and continues to **accord** me respect. However, I could have avoided the unpleasantness had I taken the time to talk to him about my **grievances**. It would be good for everyone to be more respectful and less **impulsive** in an argument.

If only we could follow the words of Chinese philosopher Zhuangzi, "We **cling** to our own point of view, as though everything depended on it. Yet our opinions have no permanence; like autumn and winter, they gradually **pass away**."

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Cling** (to) (verb) – Hold on tightly to, stick to, adhere to, पर टिके रहना

Vocabulary

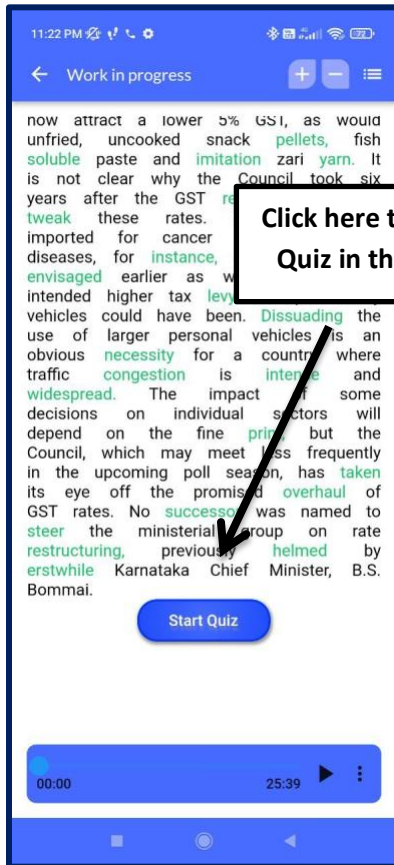
1. **Receptive** (adjective) – Open-minded, willing to accept, responsive, amenable
स्वीकार करने को तैयार
2. **Contrary** (adjective) – Opposite, opposing, conflicting, contradictory विपरीत
3. **Intertwined** (adjective) – Connected, linked, intertwined, entangled आपस में जुड़ा हुआ
4. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly अक्सर
5. **Integral** (adjective) – Essential, fundamental, vital, indispensable अविभाज्य/महत्वपूर्ण
6. **Conflicting** (adjective) – Opposing, contradictory, clashing, incompatible विरोधी
7. **Blow out of proportion** (phrase) – Exaggerate, overstate, magnify, misrepresent बढ़ा-चढ़ा कर प्रस्तुत करना
8. **Lead** (to) (verb) – Cause, result in, bring about, produce वजह बनना
9. **Unpleasantness** (noun) – Discomfort, bitterness, tension, unhappiness अप्रियता
10. **Mindful** (of) (adjective) – Aware, considerate, attentive, conscious सावधान/ध्यान में रखना
11. **Condominium Complex** (noun) – A group of privately-owned apartments or houses आवासीय परिसर
12. **Indulge** (in) (verb) – Participate, engage in, enjoy, partake लिप्त होना
13. **Idle** (adjective) – Inactive, lazy, unoccupied, useless निष्क्रिय
14. **Banter** (noun) – Playful conversation, light-hearted talk, teasing हंसी-मज़ाक
15. **Light-hearted** (adjective) – Cheerful, carefree, relaxed, humorous मजेदार/हल्का-फुल्का
16. **Chuckle** (noun) – Quiet laugh, giggle, snicker, smile हल्की हंसी
17. **Profusely** (adverb) – Abundantly, excessively, lavishly, generously बड़ी मात्रा में
18. **Faux pas** (noun) – Social mistake, blunder, slip, error सामाजिक चूक
19. **Sarcastic** (adjective) – Ironic, mocking, scornful, caustic व्यंग्यात्मक
20. **Verse** (noun) – Line of poetry, stanza, rhyme, lyric काव्य पंक्ति
21. **Considering** (preposition) – Taking into account, in view of, given that ध्यान में रखते हुए

22. **Galore** (noun) – In abundance, plenty, many, lots अधिकता में
23. **Humorous** (adjective) – Funny, amusing, comical, entertaining हास्यपूर्ण
24. **Interlude** (noun) – Break, pause, interval, respite अंतराल
25. **Seriousness** (noun) – Gravity, significance, importance, sincerity गंभीरता
26. **Adversary** (noun) – Opponent, rival, competitor, enemy प्रतिद्वंद्वी
27. **Vehemently** (adverb) – Passionately, forcefully, intensely, fervently प्रबलता से
28. **Fathom** (verb) – Understand, comprehend, grasp, figure out समझना
29. **Contention** (noun) – Disagreement, argument, dispute, assertion विवाद/दलील
30. **Go back and forth** (phrase) – Argue, debate, exchange views, discuss repeatedly आगे-पीछे बहस करना
31. **Gradual** (adjective) – Slow, progressive, step-by-step, continuous क्रमिक/धीरे-धीरे
32. **Stubborn** (adjective) – Obstinate, inflexible, rigid, unyielding हठी/ज़िद्दी
33. **Albeit** (adverb) – Although, though, even though, despite हालाँकि
34. **Reflect** (verb) – Think, consider, ponder, contemplate विचार करना
35. **Aggrieved** (adjective) – Upset, distressed, hurt, offended आहत/दुखी
36. **Transgression** (noun) – Violation, breach, offense, infringement उल्लंघन
37. **Deem** (verb) – Consider, regard, judge, believe समझना/मानना
38. **Adverse** (adjective) – Negative, unfavorable, harmful, detrimental प्रतिकूल
39. **Prospect** (noun) – Possibility, likelihood, expectation, opportunity संभावना
40. **Accord** (verb) – Grant, give, bestow, agree प्रदान करना/स्वीकार करना
41. **Grievance** (noun) – Complaint, criticism, issue, problem शिकायत
42. **Impulsive** (adjective) – Spontaneous, rash, hasty, instinctive जल्दबाज़ी में किया हुआ
43. **Pass away** (phrasal verb) – Die, expire, depart, cease to exist समाप्त हो जाना

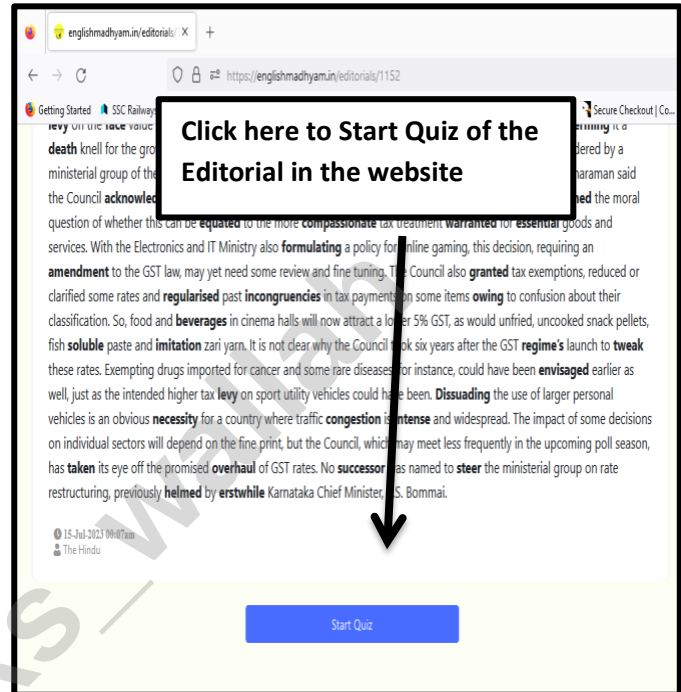
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Communication as a Social Necessity:** Human beings are inherently social, and communication plays a central role in their lives, though it can also be a source of conflict.
2. **Conflict in Close Living Spaces:** Moving from spacious bungalows to condominiums has intensified social interactions, sometimes causing friction among neighbors.
3. **Unexpected Offense:** A light-hearted comment about a neighbor's receding hairline led to serious offense, straining the relationship despite an apology.
4. **Hypocrisy in Communication:** The offended neighbor himself makes sarcastic comments in community chats, showing a lack of self-awareness.
5. **Argumentative Culture in Meetings:** Community meetings often become argumentative, with individuals pushing their views without listening to others.
6. **Bias from Personal Stakes:** A member admitted he would have opposed certain proposals had he not been part of the management team, reflecting bias.
7. **Stubbornness in Disputes:** A conflict between two ladies showed how people become stubborn in arguments, failing to realize they are saying the same thing in different words.
8. **Listening is Key:** Most arguments escalate due to a lack of listening and impulsive responses without reflecting on the other person's point of view.
9. **Learning from Past Mistakes:** The author recalls writing a complaint about a neighbor without considering its professional impact, later regretting the action.
10. **Value of Apologies:** Despite past conflicts, respectful behavior was restored after the author apologized, showing that reconciliation is possible.
11. **Avoiding Impulsive Actions:** The author emphasizes that many unpleasant situations could be avoided by communicating grievances respectfully and directly.
12. **Importance of Respect in Arguments:** Respecting others' views and maintaining a calm demeanor during discussions can reduce social friction.
13. **Reflecting on One's Behavior:** The editorial highlights the need for self-awareness and recognizing one's faults before criticizing others.
14. **Wisdom from Philosophy:** Chinese philosopher Zhuangzi's quote on the impermanence of opinions underlines the need to stay flexible in viewpoints.
15. **Call for Mutual Understanding:** The central message urges individuals to be open-minded, patient, and respectful while resolving conflicts in everyday social life.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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